

SOP Manual — QSR Chain (India)

Oct 6, 2026 · @AP

Scope, chain structure and roles

This manual is for a company-owned quick-service restaurant (QSR) chain in India with a head office, area managers and many stores, often fed by a central kitchen. The chain's promise is the same product, at the same speed, in every store, so these SOPs are written to be followed identically everywhere. Franchised stores also follow the Franchise manual.

RACI: **R** does the work · **A** signs off (one per task) · **C** consulted before · **I** informed after.

Level	Code	Role
Head office	COO	Chief Operating Officer
Head office	OPS	Head of Operations / Operations Excellence
Head office	QA	Head of Quality Assurance and Food Safety
Head office	SCM	Head of Supply Chain
Head office	CKM	Central Kitchen / Commissary Manager
Head office	MKT	Marketing and Menu Development
Head office	TRN	Training Manager
Head office	HR	HR Head
Head office	FIN	Finance Controller
Head office	IT	IT and Digital Head
Field	ARM	Area Manager (typically 6–10 stores)
Store	SM	Store / Restaurant General Manager
Store	ASM	Assistant Store Manager
Store	SFM	Shift Manager
Store	CT	Crew Trainer
Store	CR	Crew Member (counter, kitchen, drive-thru, delivery hand-off)

Licences and rules for multi-outlet chains

A chain carries two extra legal duties a single restaurant may not: menu calorie and allergen display once it runs 10 or more outlets, and a Central FSSAI licence at head office once it operates in two or more states.

Rule	Chain-level requirement	Owner
FSSAI licence per store	Each store holds its own registration or State licence by turnover	QA, SM
FSSAI Central licence	Multi-state operators hold a Central licence at the head office in addition to store licences (Setindiabiz); central kitchens licensed as manufacturing units	QA
Menu display	Chains with Central licence or 10+ outlets show kcal per serving, serving size, allergens and veg/non-veg logo on menu boards, menu cards, kiosks and apps; the standard 2,000 kcal statement displayed (Lexplosion)	MKT, QA
Aggregator listings	E-commerce platforms must display the same nutritional information (Food Safety Works)	MKT, IT
FoSTaC	One certified Food Safety Supervisor per 25 food handlers at every store and central kitchen (FSSAI)	QA, TRN
GST	Restaurant service at 5% without ITC per store GSTIN; central kitchen supplies to own stores in other states are inter-state supplies needing invoices	FIN
Service charge	No default service charge; none on takeaway	OPS
Packaging	Plastic Waste Management Rules (Extended Producer Responsibility registration for brand-owners using plastic packaging); single-use plastic ban items not used	SCM
Legal Metrology	Pre-packed items (bottled drinks, packaged desserts) carry MRP and declarations; never sell above MRP	SCM
Labour	Four Labour Codes in force; state Shops & Establishments rules on hours and night work (iPleaders)	HR

Rule	Chain-level requirement	Owner
Data	Loyalty apps, kiosks and delivery data fall under DPDP; operational duties bind from May 2027 (Uniqus)	IT
Store licences	Shops & Establishments, trade/health licence, fire NOC where required, signage, music, police eating-house where applicable	SM, Legal

Head office keeps one licence tracker for all stores with expiry dates and a 90-day renewal alert; the Area Manager checks it on every visit.

Store opening, shift and closing (ST)

Every shift starts and ends with the same signed checklist, so a store can be audited at any hour against one standard.

ST-01 Store opening (90 minutes before trading).

1. Two-person opening for safety and cash control; disarm alarm; walk the store for break-in signs.
2. Equipment on in sequence (exhaust, fryers, grills, holding cabinets, beverage machines); fryer oil checked and topped up.
3. Fridge and freezer temperatures logged; overnight deliveries checked and put away.
4. Thaw and pull schedule followed from the daily production chart.
5. Cleanliness check: dining, washrooms, kitchen; menu boards on; POS, kiosks and KDS online.
6. Cash float issued; tills counted.
7. Pre-shift huddle (5 minutes): sales target, new items, positions, food safety reminder.

ST-02 Shift change. Outgoing SFM hands over: sales vs target, stock outages, equipment faults, open complaints, cash drops done; both sign the shift log.

ST-03 Peak readiness. 30 minutes before each peak (lunch 12:00–14:30, dinner 19:00–22:00): full positioning, holding cabinets stocked to the peak chart, delivery packing station ready, extra crew on drive-thru if present.

ST-04 Closing.

1. Last order per the store's licensed hours.
2. Discard held product per holding-time rules; record waste.
3. Filter or change fryer oil; clean grills, holding cabinets, shake and beverage machines (these need daily disassembly cleaning).

4. Clean dining room and washrooms; take out trash; set rodent bait stations as mapped.
5. Z-report; cash count with two people; safe drop; deposit bag sealed.
6. Equipment off except refrigeration; gas off; alarm set.

RACI — Store routines

Activity	ARM	SM	ASM	SFM	CR
Opening checklist	I	A	R	R	R
Pre-shift huddle	-	A	R	R	I
Shift handover	-	A	R	R	-
Peak positioning	I	A	R	R	R
Closing checklist	I	A	R	R	R
Cash count and safe drop	I	A	R	R	-

Speed of service: order to hand-off (SS)

The chain targets food in the guest's hand within 3 minutes of payment at the counter, and every second is measured by the POS and KDS timestamps.

Channel	Target (payment to hand-off)
Counter / kiosk	≤ 3 minutes
Drive-thru (total time at window)	≤ 90 seconds at the pay-and-present window
Dine-in table service (where offered)	≤ 5 minutes
Delivery (order to rider hand-off)	≤ 8 minutes

SS-01 Greet and order. Greet within 10 seconds; suggest one add-on (meal upgrade, dessert) per order; repeat the order back; ask about allergies for any custom request; take payment.

SS-02 Kitchen display (KDS). Orders appear on the KDS by station; crew bump items when assembled; the SFM watches the order-time screen and moves crew when tickets turn red (over target).

SS-03 Assembly. Build each product to the build chart (sequence, weights, sauce shots); check against the picture card; wrap or box with the product label facing out.

SS-04 Presenting. Call the order number or name; check items against the receipt with the guest; offer napkins, cutlery and condiments; thank the guest.

SS-05 Order accuracy. Expeditor checks every tray and bag against the ticket; errors logged; accuracy target $\geq 98\%$.

SS-06 Recovery. Wrong or late orders are remade at once with an apology; a free item voucher within the SFM's authority; complaint recorded in the system.

RACI — Speed of service

Activity	OPS	ARM	SM	SFM	CR
Set targets	A/R	C	I	I	I
Greet and order	–	–	A	R	R
KDS management	–	–	A	R	R
Assembly to build chart	–	–	A	R	R
Order accuracy checks	I	I	A	R	R
Service recovery	–	I	A	R	R
Weekly speed review	C	A	R	C	–

Food production, holding times and food safety (FP)

Every cooked product has a maximum holding time, timer-controlled; when the timer expires the product is discarded, without exception.

Control	Standard
Chilled storage	$\leq 5^{\circ}\text{C}$
Frozen storage	$\leq -18^{\circ}\text{C}$
Fried and grilled products (chicken, patties)	Core $\geq 75^{\circ}\text{C}$, probe-checked each batch at start of shift and hourly
Hot holding cabinets	$\geq 63^{\circ}\text{C}$
Typical holding times	Fries 7 minutes; fried chicken 90 minutes; grilled patties 20 minutes — set per product by QA
Prepped salad and sauces	Use-by labels; discard at end of day or per QA shelf life
Fryer oil	Filter daily; change at 25% TPC or by the QA schedule

FP-01 Production planning. Daily production chart by 15-minute slot from the sales forecast; crew cook to the chart in off-peak and to the KDS in peak.

FP-02 Thawing. Thaw in the chiller per the pull chart (usually 12–24 hours ahead); never at room temperature or in water unless QA approves the method.

FP-03 Cooking. Fixed fryer and grill programmes; batch sizes per chart; probe and log core temperature; one crew member per station.

FP-04 Holding and timers. Every holding slot has a timer; expiry triggers discard and waste entry; FIFO rotation in the cabinet.

FP-05 Hygiene. Handwash at every task change and every 30 minutes; gloves for ready-to-eat assembly; hair caps; no jewellery; annual medical fitness certificates.

FP-06 Veg and non-veg separation. Separate fryers, utensils, prep tables and colour-coded tools; veg products never share oil with non-veg; the green and brown dot marks on packaging and boards match the product.

FP-07 Allergens. Allergen chart per product, from QA, displayed and in the app; custom orders checked by the SFM.

FP-08 Food safety audits. Daily self-check by SFM; monthly internal audit by ARM; quarterly unannounced third-party audit; score below 85% triggers a re-audit within 14 days.

RACI — Food production and safety

Activity	QA	OPS	ARM	SM	SFM	CR
Set holding times and specs	A/R	C	I	I	I	I
Production chart	–	C	–	A	R	I
Thawing and cooking	C	–	–	A	R	R
Holding timers and discard	C	–	–	A	R	R
Hygiene and medicals	C	–	I	A	R	R
Veg / non-veg separation	A	C	C	R	R	R
Allergen chart	A/R	I	–	I	I	I
Internal and third-party audits	A	C	R	R	C	–

Central kitchen, cold chain and supply (CK)

The central kitchen ships prepared, labelled product to stores on a fixed schedule, and nothing leaves it without a batch number, a use-by date and a temperature record.

CK-01 Vendor approval. QA audits every food vendor before onboarding and yearly; product specifications signed; certificates of analysis for key raw materials; FSSAI licence verified.

CK-02 Central kitchen production. HACCP plan with critical control points (cooking, cooling, metal detection where used); batch records; retained samples for each batch for the product's shelf life plus 72 hours.

CK-03 Labelling. Every pack: product name, batch, production date, use-by, storage temperature, veg/non-veg mark, allergens, FSSAI licence number of the central kitchen.

CK-04 Cold chain dispatch. Reefer vehicles pre-cooled; temperature loggers in each vehicle; loading in under 20 minutes; dispatch note lists batches and quantities.

CK-05 Store receiving. Store checks vehicle temperature reading, pack integrity and use-by; probes a sample; rejects anything out of limits through the app; puts away within 15 minutes.

CK-06 Ordering and forecasting. Stores order in the system by the cut-off (for example 14:00 for next-day delivery) from suggested orders based on sales forecast and on-hand stock; ARM approves exceptions.

CK-07 Traceability and recall readiness. One-step-back, one-step-forward traceability for every batch; a mock recall every 6 months must trace 100% of a batch within 4 hours.

RACI — Central kitchen and supply

Activity	QA	SCM	CKM	ARM	SM	FIN
Vendor approval and audit	A	R	C	–	–	C
HACCP plan and production	A	–	R	–	–	–
Labelling	A	C	R	–	–	–
Cold chain dispatch	C	A	R	–	I	–
Store receiving	C	I	–	I	A/R	–
Store ordering	–	C	C	C	A/R	–
Mock recall	A	R	R	R	R	–

Store inventory, cash and POS (IC)

Each store's actual food cost must sit within 1 percentage point of its theoretical cost, and its cash within ₹100 of the POS, every day.

IC-01 Daily count of key items. At close, count 10–15 high-value or high-theft items (proteins, cheese, beverages, packaging); enter in the system; variances flagged next morning.

IC-02 Weekly full count. Full inventory every week on a fixed day; actual vs theoretical (from POS sales × recipe) usage report reviewed by SM and ARM.

IC-03 Waste. Every discard (expired holding time, damaged, returned) logged at the station with reason; waste above 1.5% of food sales reviewed.

IC-04 Cash handling. Till per cashier; skim drops to the safe when the till exceeds the set limit; two-person count at close; safe counted at each manager change; deposits via cash pickup or bank the next day.

IC-05 Refunds, voids, discounts. Manager card or PIN; reason code; daily exception report sent to ARM; any staff with repeated voids reviewed.

IC-06 Digital payments. UPI and card terminals reconciled daily to the settlement report; failed transactions handled per the bank's chargeback timeline.

RACI — Inventory and cash

Activity	FIN	ARM	SM	ASM	SFM	CR
Daily key-item count	–	I	A	R	R	–
Weekly count and variance	C	C	A	R	R	–
Waste logging	–	I	A	R	R	R
Cash and safe drops	C	I	A	R	R	R
Voids and refunds	I	C	A	R	R	–
Payment reconciliation	A	I	R	R	–	–

Delivery, digital orders and kiosks (DG)

All channels — own app, website, kiosks and aggregators — run off one central menu and price book managed by head office; stores never edit menus locally.

DG-01 Central menu management. MKT publishes menu, prices, images, kcal, allergens and veg/non-veg marks to all channels from one source; changes go live at a set time; IT checks every channel within 1 hour.

DG-02 Item availability (86-ing). Store marks an item out of stock in the POS, which syncs to all channels within 5 minutes; SM restores it when stock returns; repeated stock-outs flagged to SCM.

DG-03 Order intake. Aggregator and app orders auto-accepted into the POS and KDS; store tablets monitored if integration fails; prep starts on acceptance.

DG-04 Packing and seals. Food-safe packaging; hot and cold items separate; tamper-evident seal; bag checked against the ticket by the expeditor; rider handed the bag only with matching order ID.

DG-05 Own-fleet delivery (if used). Riders with valid licence, helmet, insulated bag; speed limits observed (no pressure for unsafe delivery times); accident insurance for riders.

DG-06 Kiosks. Cleaned every hour; receipt paper stocked; payment terminal tested at opening; accessible height and screen-reader mode where available.

DG-07 Ratings and complaints. Central customer-care team handles complaints within 24 hours; store-attributed issues sent to SM; refunds per policy; patterns reported weekly.

DG-08 Customer data. Loyalty sign-up with a clear privacy notice; marketing only with consent; delete inactive accounts per the retention policy; vendor contracts with app and CRM providers include security clauses.

RACI — Digital and delivery

Activity	MKT	IT	OPS	SM	SFM	CR
Central menu publishing	A/R	R	C	I	I	–
Item availability sync	–	C	I	A	R	R
Order intake	–	C	–	A	R	R
Packing and seal	–	–	C	A	R	R
Kiosk upkeep	–	C	–	A	R	R
Complaints and ratings	C	–	A	R	–	–
Customer data and consent	R	A/R	I	I	–	–

Crew scheduling, training and certification (CT)

No crew member works a station alone until a Crew Trainer has certified them on it, and labour is scheduled to forecast sales in 15-minute blocks.

CT-01 Labour scheduling. Weekly schedule built from the sales forecast and the labour guide (crew hours per ₹ of sales per daypart); published 7 days ahead; respects weekly hours, rest days, overtime rules and state night-work rules; target labour cost set by OPS.

CT-02 Hiring. Central job descriptions; walk-in and campus hiring; ID and age verification (no one under 18 on fryers, slicers or late shifts); medical fitness certificate; appointment letter.

CT-03 Station certification path.

1. Day 1: orientation, hygiene, safety, brand values, POSH, cash basics.
2. Days 2–10: e-learning module per station plus shadowing.
3. Crew Trainer observes the crew member on a Station Observation Checklist (SOC); pass mark 90%.
4. Certified stations recorded in the training system; recertification every 12 months.

CT-04 Manager development. Crew → Crew Trainer → Shift Manager → Assistant Store Manager → Store Manager, each with a modular course and an assessment by the ARM; FoSTaC Advanced certification for every shift manager.

CT-05 Performance and recognition. Monthly crew recognition by speed, accuracy and audit scores; quarterly reviews for managers.

CT-06 Wellbeing and safety. Burn and cut first aid; non-slip shoes; heat stress breaks in summer; transport for late closers; grievance hotline.

RACI — Crew and training

Activity	HR	TRN	OPS	ARM	SM	CT
Labour guide and targets	C	–	A/R	C	I	–
Weekly schedule	I	–	–	C	A/R	–
Hiring	A	–	–	C	R	–
Training content	C	A/R	C	–	–	I
Station certification	I	C	–	I	A	R
Manager development	C	R	C	A	R	–
FoSTaC coverage	I	R	–	A	R	–

Field operations: audits, visits and KPIs (FO)

Each Area Manager visits every store at least weekly with a structured visit report, and every store is ranked monthly on the same scorecard.

FO-01 Area Manager visit. Agenda: walk the store as a guest; check food safety log, holding timers, cleanliness; observe one peak; review P&L, speed, accuracy, complaints, staffing; coach the SM; agree three actions with owners and dates; upload the visit report within 24 hours.

FO-02 Audits.

Audit	Frequency	Done by	Pass mark
Food safety self-check	Every shift	SFM	100% of critical items
Operations and food safety audit	Monthly	ARM	85%
Unannounced QA / third-party audit	Quarterly	QA or agency	85%, zero critical failures
Mystery guest	Monthly	Agency	80%
Cash and inventory audit	Surprise, quarterly	FIN	No unexplained variance

A critical failure (temperature abuse, pest activity, no FSS on shift, expired product in use) means immediate correction and a re-audit within 7 days.

FO-03 Store scorecard.

KPI	Typical target
Same-store sales growth	Annual plan
Speed of service (counter)	≤ 3 minutes
Order accuracy	≥ 98%
Food cost variance	≤ 1 point vs theoretical
Labour cost %	Set by OPS
Audit score	≥ 85%
Guest satisfaction / aggregator rating	≥ 4.2
Crew turnover (annual)	Set by HR

FO-04 Monthly business review. ARM with each SM, then OPS with all ARMs: scorecard, bottom-10 stores' action plans, best-practice sharing.

RACI — Field operations

Activity	COO	OPS	QA	ARM	SM
Weekly store visit	I	C	-	A/R	R

Activity	COO	OPS	QA	ARM	SM
Monthly ops audit	I	C	C	A/R	R
QA / third-party audit	I	I	A/R	I	R
Store scorecard	C	A/R	C	R	I
Monthly business review	A	R	C	R	R
Critical failure correction	I	I	C	A	R

New store opening and menu launch (NS)

A new store opens only after its licences are in hand, its crew is certified, and a soft-opening trial has passed the operations audit.

NS-01 New store opening, from site to launch.

1. **Site approval (week –20):** catchment, footfall, rent-to-sales ratio, visibility; investment committee sign-off.
2. **Lease and licences (weeks –20 to –4):** lease signed; Shops & Establishments, FSSAI, trade licence, fire NOC, signage, GST registration where needed; tracker shared weekly.
3. **Fit-out (weeks –14 to –3):** layout from the standard design; kitchen equipment installed; gas and electrical certified; pest proofing.
4. **Hiring and training (weeks –6 to –1):** SM and ASM trained in a certified training store; crew certified on all stations; FoSTaC supervisors in place.
5. **Systems (week –2):** POS, KDS, aggregators, payment terminals, CCTV, inventory system live and tested.
6. **Soft opening (week –1):** 3 days of friends-and-family trading; ARM audit must score $\geq$ 85%.
7. **Launch (week 0):** marketing activation; OPS and ARM on site for the first weekend; 30-day review.

NS-02 New menu item launch.

1. MKT and culinary develop the product; QA approves specifications, shelf life, allergens, kcal.
2. SCM confirms supply and cost; FIN approves price and margin.
3. Pilot in 5–10 stores for 2–4 weeks; measure sales, speed impact, waste, guest feedback.
4. National rollout: training module, build chart, menu boards and digital listings updated on the same day; crew trained before launch day.

RACI — New stores and launches

Activity	COO	OPS	QA	SCM	MKT	TRN	FIN	ARM	SM
Site approval	A	R	-	-	C	-	R	C	-
Licences tracker	I	A	R	-	-	-	-	R	R
Fit-out	I	A	C	C	-	-	C	R	C
Store team training	I	C	C	-	-	A/R	-	R	R
Soft-opening audit	I	A	C	-	-	-	-	R	R
Product development	I	C	R	C	A/R	-	C	-	-
Pilot and rollout	A	R	C	R	R	R	C	R	R

Incidents, recalls and compliance calendar (IN)

Any incident that could reach more than one store (contaminated batch, viral complaint, data breach) is escalated to head office within 1 hour.

IN-01 Escalation matrix.

Severity	Examples	Escalate to	Within
Level 1	Single complaint, minor injury, equipment failure	SM, ARM	Same shift
Level 2	Foreign object in food, illness complaint, police visit, authority inspection, robbery	ARM, OPS, QA	1 hour
Level 3	Multiple illnesses, batch contamination, fire, death, social media crisis, data breach	COO, QA, Legal, PR	Immediately

IN-02 Product hold and recall.

1. QA issues a hold notice through the store app: product, batch numbers, action (quarantine, do not sell).
2. Stores confirm quarantine within 1 hour and report quantities.
3. QA investigates; decides to release or recall; informs FSSAI where the Food Safety and Standards (Food Recall Procedure) Regulations 2017 apply.
4. Stock is returned to the central kitchen or destroyed with records; root cause and corrective action documented.

IN-03 Media and social media. Only the designated spokesperson speaks for the brand; store staff never comment; a holding statement within 2 hours for a Level 3 event.

IN-04 Data breach. IT isolates systems, informs Legal, reports to CERT-In within 6 hours and to the Data Protection Board and affected people as the DPDP Rules require.

RACI — Incidents

Activity	COO	OPS	QA	IT	ARM	SM
Level 1 response	–	I	–	–	A	R
Level 2 response	I	A	R	–	R	R
Level 3 response	A	R	R	C	R	R
Product hold / recall	I	C	A/R	–	R	R
Media statement	A	C	C	–	–	–
Data breach	A	I	–	R	–	I

Compliance calendar

Frequency	Task	Owner
Every shift	Temperature and holding logs, FSS present, cash count	SFM
Weekly	ARM visit, full inventory, oil and equipment checks	ARM, SM
Monthly	Ops audit, pest control, GST returns per GSTIN, payroll statutory deposits	ARM, FIN, HR
Quarterly	Third-party audit, mystery guest summary, menu kcal/allergen check across channels	QA, MKT
Every 6 months	Mock recall, water tests, duct cleaning, fire drills	QA, SM
Annually	Food handler medicals, FSSAI annual returns (Form D1 by 31 May), EPR filing for plastic packaging, licence renewals, SOP review	QA, SCM, OPS

Sources

- [FSSAI FoSTaC](#)
- [Menu labelling for chains with 10+ outlets](#)
- [FSSAI order on e-commerce menu display](#)
- [Central licence for multi-state operators](#)
- [Labour Codes implementation](#)
- [DPDP timelines](#)

Operational guidance only, not legal advice.